

Foods for Babies (First Year)

Introduction to Solids and Weaning

The first year of life is a period of rapid growth and development. Exclusive breastfeeding is recommended for the first six months. After that, solid foods are gradually introduced while breastfeeding continues.

Stages of Introduction

From six months, mashed and pureed foods are introduced one at a time. From eight to nine months, soft lumpy foods and finger foods can be offered. By twelve months, most babies can eat family meals in smaller pieces with appropriate texture modifications.

Suitable First Foods

Single-grain cereals, mashed fruits and vegetables, and pureed legumes are common first foods. New foods should be introduced one at a time, with a few days between each, to monitor for any reactions.

Suggested Items:

- Rice or ragi cereal mixed with expressed milk or water
- Mashed banana - soft, easy to digest, sweet
- Pureed apple or pear, well cooked
- Mashed cooked dal with a touch of ghee
- Pureed vegetables - carrot, pumpkin, sweet potato
- Soft idli or well-cooked rice khichdi

Food	Age (months)	Texture
Rice cereal	6+	Thin puree
Mashed banana	6+	Smooth
Apple puree	6+	Smooth
Khichdi	8+	Soft, mashed
Finger foods	9+	Soft pieces

Conclusion

Honey, cow's milk as a main drink, nuts (whole), and salty or sugary foods should be avoided in the first year. Always consult a pediatrician for individual guidance.